

DedicatusIT Service Delivery Operating System

The SDM playbook for the dedicated-technician model — how we deliver the service so the MSP never wants to do it without us.

The one idea this whole system protects

A dedicated technician embeds so deeply into the MSP that, after a while, the MSP stops feeling DedicatusIT and just feels “their engineer.” That closeness is our value and our biggest risk at once. The moment an owner thinks “*we could just hire this person directly and save the margin,*” we are exposed. Everything in this playbook exists to make that thought never occur — by delivering, visibly, the things a direct hire could never give them.

We serve two customers, not one. The MSP, and the technician. They can quietly pull apart — an overworked, disengaged tech while the MSP thinks all is well — and the first sign is often a resignation. Seeing that gap early is this system's core job.

Four risks we manage on every placement: continuity (what if the tech leaves), engagement (keeping the tech so they don't), visible value (so we're not cut out), and expansion (growing the account).

1 · The SDM's job (the spine)

You do not manage the technician's daily work — the MSP does. Your job is the layer around the seat that makes the arrangement worth a margin. Concretely, you own four things: keep both sides healthy, make our value visible, protect continuity, and grow the account. Be clear about who owns what:

DedicatusIT (you / the SDM) owns	The MSP owns
Relationship health (both sides); the technician's growth, recognition and day-to-day direct quality standards; knowledge shift path, cleavage, pro value	

If the MSP can name three things they get from us that a direct hire wouldn't give them, the account is safe. If they can't, we're exposed. Your week is spent making those three things real and felt.

2 · Placement & fit foundation

A placement that starts well rarely goes badly. Get three things right up front:

Define the seat with the MSP

- Agree what the seat is for, what “good” looks like in 90 days, and which tools and access the tech needs.
- Walk through the ownership split above so expectations are explicit from day one.
- Capture it on the Seat Definition & RACI template — vague seats drift and disappoint.

Match the person, not just the skills

- For an embedded role, fit and temperament matter as much as raw skill — they're joining a team, not a queue.
- Be honest with the MSP about what the person is strong at and still growing into. Oversell creates the first crack.

Run a deliberate first 30 / 60 / 90

- 30: access working, introductions made, shadowing, first tickets, knowledge capture started.
- 60: owning their area, embedded in the team's rhythm, first value visible to the MSP.
- 90: fully productive, a documented footprint, first growth conversation. Use the 30/60/90 Embed Checklist.

3 · The two-sided health system

This is the part a staffing platform doesn't have, and it's where you earn your keep. Read *both* sides on a rhythm, and watch the gap between them.

- **Weekly tech pulse** — a light, human check-in with the technician. Not a status report; a read on workload, mood, blockers, whether they feel set up to succeed.
- **Bi-weekly MSP cadence** — a standing conversation with the MSP (see section 4).
- **Score each placement Green / Amber / Red on both axes** — MSP satisfaction and tech engagement — on the Two-Sided Health Scorecard. Two greens is healthy. Any red, or a widening gap between the two, is your priority that week.

The gap detector — signs the tech is struggling that the MSP won't report

- Going quiet, shorter answers, less initiative than a month ago.
- Consistently working beyond their hours; “it's fine” said too quickly.
- Stopped asking questions or contributing ideas; just executing.
- Friction with a team member they won't name to the MSP.
- These rarely reach the MSP until the resignation. Catching one early, and acting, is the single most valuable thing you do.

4 · Staying visibly valuable (so we're never cut out)

Embeddedness makes us invisible. The cure isn't being intrusive — it's delivering named things the MSP would lose if they hired the tech directly, and making them felt.

The “you'd lose this if you hired them direct” list

- A second brain: senior escalation support behind the tech when they're stuck.
- Coverage: a plan for leave, sickness and emergencies, so the seat never just goes dark.
- A quality standard the tech is held to (worknotes, discipline) — not left to drift.
- Active development that keeps the tech sharper than a static hire would stay.
- Continuity insurance: if the tech leaves, it's a managed transition, not a crisis.
- A relationship owner (you) who stays accountable for all of the above.

The bi-weekly cadence is the product made visible

Its purpose is not a status update — the MSP already knows the status. It surfaces trajectory and protects the relationship. A good agenda: how's the work trending; is the tech growing into more; any friction building (either side); anything more the MSP would hand over if they trusted us with it; confirm both-sides health. Never “everything good? great, bye.” Use the cadence template.

Send a short monthly value note — a few lines on what the tech delivered, what's improved, what's next. It keeps us felt without taking the MSP's time.

5 · Growth & development (the retention moat)

An engaged, growing technician doesn't leave — and low turnover is the MSP's win as much as ours. This is how we keep the person, which is how we keep the account.

- Every technician has a development path: a skill or certification target each quarter, and recognition when they hit it.
- A quarterly growth conversation, separate from the weekly pulse — where are they headed, what do they want next.
- Make their growth visible to the MSP too: “your engineer just earned X” reinforces that we're investing in the person on their account.

6 · Continuity & knowledge (insuring the MSP's deepest fear)

The unspoken worry about embedding an outsider: “what happens when they leave, and the knowledge walks out?” It's the exact fear we sell against in outreach. Answer it in our own service and it becomes our strongest selling point.

- **Capture from day one:** the tech documents the environment and recurring work as they go — not in their head. Track it on the Continuity & Knowledge checklist.
- **A warm bench / relief concept:** someone who can step in for leave, sickness or a gap, with enough context to be useful.
- **A transition playbook:** if a tech moves on, a structured, calm handover — overlap, documentation transfer, introductions — so the MSP feels protected, not abandoned.
- Said plainly to a prospect: *“if our engineer ever leaves, that's our problem to absorb, not yours.”* That is a sentence a direct hire can never offer.

7 · Account growth & expansion

- Most growth comes from existing accounts: a second seat, a wider scope, or more trust handed over.
- The cadence is where you hear expansion signals — “we’re swamped in X,” “we’re losing someone,” “could your person also...” Log them.
- Run a light quarterly review (QBR) with the MSP: relationship health, what’s working, what’s next. That’s where one seat becomes two.
- Track signals and seats on the QBR / Expansion sheet.

8 · Metrics that matter (and the ones to ignore)

Don’t measure this like a NOC. Throughput metrics miss the point of a dedicated seat. Track instead:

- Placement health — the two-sided Green/Amber/Red, trended over time.
- Technician tenure and engagement — our retention is the leading indicator of account retention.
- MSP renewal and expansion — seats added, scope widened.
- Continuity readiness — is the knowledge captured, is there relief cover.
- Cadence adherence — are the pulses and check-ins actually happening.
- Largely ignore: ticket counts and raw throughput. The MSP measures the tech’s output; we measure the health of the arrangement.

9 · When a client needs full NOC delivery

Dedicated-tech is the core model; some clients will want full NOC coverage instead. When they do, the team runs to our NOC & Service-Desk Operating Standard (shifts, handover, escalation, headcount via the calculator) — but this relationship system still governs: two-sided health, visible value, continuity and expansion apply just the same.

The operating rhythm at a glance

Rhythm	What happens
Weekly	Tech pulse (SDM ↔ technician); update each placement’s health score
Bi-weekly	MSP cadence call — trajectory, friction, expansion, health
Monthly	Short value note to the MSP; review Amber/Red placements
Quarterly	Tech growth conversation; MSP QBR & expansion review
Always-on	Knowledge capture; relief readiness; act on any red the moment it appears

The whole system in one line: the MSP governs the work; we own the relationship, the person, the continuity and the growth — so cutting us out would cost them more than it saves.

— *DedicatusIT Service Delivery Operating System · SDM playbook · v1*